

Real Estate Dialogue Lab

Realistic real-estate-workplace dialogues, role-play cards, and debrief prompts for advanced ESL learners

Audience: instructors, real estate English coaches, brokerage trainers, property management teams, transaction teams, and peer practice cohorts

Focus: high-level professional English for real estate workplaces, including agency, representation agreements, buyer and seller consultations, pricing, property descriptions, fair housing, offers, contingencies, inspections, appraisals, financing, disclosures, title, escrow, closings, leasing, commercial basics, and realistic transaction dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who work as agents, brokers, assistants, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing staff, commercial real estate staff, relocation specialists, mortgage-adjacent staff, title-adjacent staff, or real-estate business partners.

Teaching stance: real estate English is trust, precision, and risk control under time pressure. Learners need language that is persuasive but not misleading, helpful but not discriminatory, confident but not legally careless. This curriculum teaches professional communication and judgment, not state-specific legal advice.

How to Run the Dialogue Lab

1. Use groups of three: real estate professional, client or stakeholder, observer.
2. Read the model dialogue once. Then replay it with a different property type, market condition, jurisdictional rule, contract term, or stakeholder pressure.
3. The observer listens for role clarity, fair-housing-safe language, document awareness, objective evidence, risk explanation, and next-step control.
4. After each role-play, replay the hardest 30 seconds with a more precise real estate sentence.

Facilitator guardrail

Do not let learners give confident legal or lending advice. Ask them to separate real estate process language from legal, tax, lending, inspection, title, escrow, and brokerage-policy decisions.

1. Buyer Consultation: Agreement Before Touring

Setting

A buyer wants to see a house immediately but has not discussed representation or compensation.

Speaker	Line
Buyer	Can you show me the house this afternoon? I do not want to sign anything yet.
Agent	I understand. Before I tour property with you as your agent, we need a written agreement that explains my services, the term, and how compensation works.
ESL learner	This agreement is not meant to pressure you. It defines who I represent, what I can do for you, and what compensation we agree to. We can keep the term narrow if you only want to evaluate this property.
Buyer	So I have to pay you?
ESL learner	Compensation is negotiable and may be paid in different ways depending on the offer and transaction. The important point is that we discuss it clearly before we start representation.

Language notes

- Explain agreement and compensation calmly before advice becomes transaction-specific.
- Use transparent language without implying compensation is fixed or required by law.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Compensation is negotiable and may be paid in different ways depending on the offer and transaction. The important point is that we discuss it clearly before we start _____.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	representation

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A buyer wants to see a house immediately but has not discussed representation or compensation.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming representation until the discussion is over.
B	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
C	evidence threshold
D	Compensation is negotiable and may be paid in different ways depending on the offer and transaction. The important point is that we discuss it clearly before we start representation.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A buyer wants to see a house immediately but has not discussed representation or compensation.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Verify representation, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

2. Fair Housing Question: 'Is This a Good Neighborhood?'

Setting

A buyer asks for subjective neighborhood advice that could lead to steering.

Speaker	Line
Buyer	Is this a good neighborhood for families like us?
Agent	I can help you compare objective information, but I cannot steer you based on who lives here.
ESL learner	Let's define what 'good' means for you: commute time, budget, property condition, parks, school district boundaries, noise, transit, or walkability. I can point you to public resources so you can evaluate the area using your own priorities.
Buyer	But would you live here?
ESL learner	I should not substitute my personal preference for your decision. I can give you property facts and objective sources, and you can decide whether the area fits your needs.

Language notes

- Do not shame the client; redirect to objective criteria.
- Avoid statements that imply preference based on protected-class characteristics.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

I should not substitute my personal preference for your decision. I can give you property facts and objective sources, and you can decide _____ the area fits your needs.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	whether
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A buyer asks for subjective neighborhood advice that could lead to steering.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	I should not substitute my personal preference for your decision. I can give you property facts and objective sources, and you can decide whether the area fits your needs.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A buyer asks for subjective neighborhood advice that could lead to steering.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
B	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
C	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
D	Verify whether, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

3. Listing Presentation: Seller Wants an Unrealistic Price

Setting

A seller wants to list far above the CMA range because a neighbor got a high price last year.

Speaker	Line
Seller	My neighbor sold for more last year. I want to list at that number plus 10 percent.
Listing agent	The market has changed since then.
ESL learner	We can test a premium only if the evidence supports it. The closest recent comps show lower closed prices, longer DOM, and seller concessions. If we list too high, we may reduce urgency and help competing listings look more attractive.
Seller	I do not want to leave money on the table.
ESL learner	Neither do I. My recommendation is a price that creates serious buyer activity and gives us leverage. We can also agree now on a review point if showings or feedback are weak.

Language notes

- Pricing pushback should protect the relationship and the market logic.
- Use data, timing, and adjustment plan instead of arguing over ego.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Neither do I. My recommendation is a price that creates serious buyer activity and gives us leverage. We can also agree now on a review point if showings or _____ are weak.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	feedback
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A seller wants to list far above the CMA range because a neighbor got a high price last year.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I can approve the result now and look at feedback after the decision.
B	Let's avoid naming feedback until the discussion is over.
C	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
D	Neither do I. My recommendation is a price that creates serious buyer activity and gives us leverage. We can also agree now on a review point if showings or feedback are weak.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A seller wants to list far above the CMA range because a neighbor got a high price last year.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
D	Verify feedback, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

4. Multiple Offers: Stronger Terms vs Higher Price

Setting

A buyer wants to win in a competitive situation but does not understand the risk of waiving protections.

Speaker	Line
Buyer	Let's waive everything and offer over asking.
Agent	That may strengthen the offer, but it changes your risk.
ESL learner	We should compare price, appraisal gap, inspection rights, financing contingency, earnest money, closing date, and seller priorities. A stronger offer is not just a higher price. It is also certainty and clean terms.
Buyer	Can we waive inspection?
ESL learner	You can choose that strategy, but I want you to understand the risk. Another option is a shorter inspection period, informational inspection, or cap on repair requests, depending on local practice and your comfort level.

Language notes

- Protect the distinction between competitiveness and risk.
- Do not make waiver decisions sound routine or harmless.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

You can choose that strategy, but I want you to understand the _____. Another option is a shorter inspection period, informational inspection, or cap on repair requests, depending on local practice and your comfort level.

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A buyer wants to win in a competitive situation but does not understand the risk of waiving protections.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	You can choose that strategy, but I want you to understand the risk. Another option is a shorter inspection period, informational inspection, or cap on repair requests, depending on local practice and your comfort level.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A buyer wants to win in a competitive situation but does not understand the risk of waiving protections.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

5. Inspection Negotiation: Repair Credit

Setting

An inspection found roof and electrical issues. The buyer is angry and wants the seller to fix everything.

Speaker	Line
Buyer	This house has problems. Ask them to fix every item.
Agent	We need to separate major issues from normal maintenance.
ESL learner	The strongest request will focus on safety, systems, and cost. Instead of sending a long emotional list, we can ask for a licensed electrician to address the panel issue and request a credit toward the roof repair, supported by the inspection report and estimate.
Buyer	What if they refuse?
ESL learner	Then we evaluate your contract options, your appetite for repairs, and whether a revised price or credit makes the risk acceptable.

Language notes

- Convert anger into specific, document-supported requests.
- Separate inspection facts from negotiation strategy.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then we evaluate your contract options, your appetite for repairs, and whether a revised price or credit makes the _____ acceptable.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	risk

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (An inspection found roof and electrical issues. The buyer is angry and wants the seller to fix everything.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Then we evaluate your contract options, your appetite for repairs, and whether a revised price or credit makes the risk acceptable.
B	I can approve the result now and look at risk after the decision.
C	Let's avoid naming risk until the discussion is over.
D	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (An inspection found roof and electrical issues. The buyer is angry and wants the seller to fix everything.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

6. Low Appraisal: Contract Price Is Higher Than Appraised Value

Setting

The appraisal comes in below contract price and financing is affected.

Speaker	Line
Lender	The appraisal is twenty thousand below contract price.
Buyer	Does that mean the deal is dead?
ESL learner	Not automatically. We have several paths: challenge the appraisal if there are factual issues, renegotiate price, increase down payment, use an appraisal-gap clause if one exists, or cancel if the contract allows it.
Buyer	What should we do?
ESL learner	First, let's review the appraisal with the lender and compare it to our comps. Then we can choose a negotiation position based on your cash, contract rights, and risk tolerance.

Language notes

- Low appraisal language should be calm and options-based.
- Do not promise the appraisal can be changed.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

First, let's review the appraisal with the lender and compare it to our comps. Then we can choose a negotiation position based on your cash, contract rights, and _____ tolerance.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	risk
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (The appraisal comes in below contract price and financing is affected.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	First, let's review the appraisal with the lender and compare it to our comps. Then we can choose a negotiation position based on your cash, contract rights, and risk tolerance.
B	I can approve the result now and look at risk after the decision.
C	Let's avoid naming risk until the discussion is over.
D	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (The appraisal comes in below contract price and financing is affected.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

7. Financing Delay: Underwriting Conditions

Setting

Closing is approaching but the lender still needs documentation.

Speaker	Line
Seller agent	Are your buyers clear to close? We need certainty.
Buyer agent	The file is still in underwriting.
ESL learner	The lender has issued conditional approval and is waiting on two documents from the buyer. We expect an update tomorrow afternoon. I do not want to overpromise, so I will send a written status update by 4 p.m. with any impact on closing.
Seller agent	Should we issue a notice?
ESL learner	I understand your concern. Please send any contract notice through the proper channel. Meanwhile, I will keep the timeline, owner, and dependency clear for everyone.

Language notes

- Use precise status language: condition, owner, deadline, impact.
- Avoid blaming lender or buyer while uncertainty remains.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

I understand your concern. Please send any contract notice through the proper channel. Meanwhile, I will keep the timeline, _____, and dependency clear for everyone.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	evidence threshold
C	owner
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Closing is approaching but the lender still needs documentation.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming owner until the discussion is over.
B	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
C	I understand your concern. Please send any contract notice through the proper channel. Meanwhile, I will keep the timeline, owner, and dependency clear for everyone.
D	I can approve the result now and look at owner after the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Closing is approaching but the lender still needs documentation.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Verify owner, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
B	decision owner
C	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
D	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

8. RESPA Risk: Referral Benefit

Setting

A settlement-service provider offers valuable benefits for referrals.

Speaker	Line
Vendor	If you send us your buyers, we can sponsor your client event and give you premium tickets.
Agent	That sounds generous, but we need to be careful.
ESL learner	I cannot accept anything of value in exchange for settlement-service referrals. If we discuss marketing or sponsorship, it must be reviewed by the broker and compliance, tied to real services, and not conditioned on referrals.
Vendor	Everyone does it.
ESL learner	Our policy is to protect clients and avoid referral-kickback risk. I can share your public information with clients if they ask for options, but I cannot trade referrals for benefits.

Language notes

- Referral pressure requires direct, documented refusal.
- Use broker and compliance review rather than improvising.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Our policy is to protect clients and avoid referral-kickback _____. I can share your public information with clients if they ask for options, but I cannot trade referrals for benefits.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	risk

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A settlement-service provider offers valuable benefits for referrals.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Our policy is to protect clients and avoid referral-kickback risk. I can share your public information with clients if they ask for options, but I cannot trade referrals for benefits.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A settlement-service provider offers valuable benefits for referrals.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

9. Seller Disclosure: Known Water Intrusion

Setting

A seller wants to avoid disclosing a past water problem because it was repaired.

Speaker	Line
Seller	Do we really need to mention the basement leak? It was fixed two years ago.
Agent	Known property issues can create disclosure duties.
ESL learner	I cannot tell you how to complete the legal disclosure form, but I can tell you not to hide known facts. Let's review the form instructions, gather repair records, and if you are unsure, ask your attorney before we publish or respond to buyers.
Seller	I am afraid buyers will panic.
ESL learner	Clear disclosure with documentation can reduce surprises later. A hidden issue can create a much larger trust and contract problem.

Language notes

- Do not complete legal disclosure decisions for the client.
- Encourage truth, documentation, and expert review.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Clear disclosure with documentation can reduce surprises later. A hidden issue can create a much larger trust and contract _____.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	problem

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A seller wants to avoid disclosing a past water problem because it was repaired.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	Clear disclosure with documentation can reduce surprises later. A hidden issue can create a much larger trust and contract problem.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A seller wants to avoid disclosing a past water problem because it was repaired.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
B	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
C	evidence threshold
D	Verify problem, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

10. Lead-Based Paint Disclosure

Setting

A pre-1978 home is going under contract and documents are incomplete.

Speaker	Line
Transaction coordinator	The lead disclosure form is missing the buyer acknowledgment.
Agent	Can we just send it after signatures?
ESL learner	For pre-1978 housing, the lead disclosure process needs to be handled before the buyer is obligated under the contract. We need the required pamphlet, known information, available records, and signed acknowledgment in the file.
Agent	The seller does not know of any lead paint.
ESL learner	That may be the seller's disclosure position, but the required disclosure process still matters. Let's correct the file before moving forward.

Language notes

- Lead disclosure is a document and timing conversation, not only a knowledge conversation.
- Use process language and file discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

That may be the seller's disclosure position, but the required disclosure process still matters. Let's correct the file before moving _____.

Option	Phrase
A	Lead disclosure
B	forward
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A pre-1978 home is going under contract and documents are incomplete.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	That may be the seller's disclosure position, but the required disclosure process still matters. Let's correct the file before moving forward.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A pre-1978 home is going under contract and documents are incomplete.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Verify forward, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

11. Dual Agency or Same-Brokerage Conflict

Setting

A buyer wants to make an offer on a listing held by the same brokerage.

Speaker	Line
Buyer	Can you still represent me if your office has the listing?
Agent	It depends on state law, brokerage policy, and the agency structure.
ESL learner	We need to disclose the relationship clearly and explain whether this is dual agency, designated agency, or another permitted arrangement. You should understand what advice I can and cannot give before you decide whether to consent.
Buyer	Will you tell me what the seller will accept?
ESL learner	I cannot share confidential information from another client or side. My role and limits must be clear before we proceed.

Language notes

- Conflict language should be explicit, not casual.
- Confidentiality survives pressure from the other side.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

I cannot share confidential information from another client or side. My role and limits must be clear before we _____.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	proceed
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A buyer wants to make an offer on a listing held by the same brokerage.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	I can approve the result now and look at proceed after the decision.
C	I cannot share confidential information from another client or side. My role and limits must be clear before we proceed.
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A buyer wants to make an offer on a listing held by the same brokerage.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Verify proceed, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
B	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
C	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

12. Commercial Lease: NNN and TI Allowance

Setting

A small business owner is reviewing a commercial lease proposal.

Speaker	Line
Tenant	The rent looks affordable. It says NNN, CAM, and TI allowance. What does that mean?
Commercial agent	Those terms affect your real occupancy cost.
ESL learner	Base rent is only one part. NNN usually means you may pay taxes, insurance, and maintenance in addition to base rent. CAM covers common area maintenance. A TI allowance is landlord contribution toward tenant improvements, but the lease will define conditions and repayment risk.
Tenant	So can I sign the LOI?
ESL learner	An LOI can frame the deal, but you should review lease language with legal and financial advisors before committing. Let's compare total occupancy cost, term, options, buildout timeline, and exit risk.

Language notes

- Commercial terms need plain-English financial consequences.
- Refer legal and tax interpretation to qualified advisors.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

An LOI can frame the deal, but you should review lease language with legal and financial advisors before committing. Let's compare total occupancy cost, term, options, buildout timeline, and exit _____.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	risk
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A small business owner is reviewing a commercial lease proposal.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	An LOI can frame the deal, but you should review lease language with legal and financial advisors before committing. Let's compare total occupancy cost, term, options, buildout timeline, and exit risk.
B	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A small business owner is reviewing a commercial lease proposal.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify role, document, source, or decision owner?
- Did the learner avoid discriminatory, misleading, or overpromising language?
- Did the learner explain the tradeoff or risk in plain English?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step and document what should happen next?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

1. Buyer Consultation: Agreement Before Touring - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. representation	'representation' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

1. Buyer Consultation: Agreement Before Touring - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Compensation is negotiable and may be paid in different ways depending on the offer and transaction. The important point is that we discuss it clearly before we start representation.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

1. Buyer Consultation: Agreement Before Touring - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify representation, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

2. Fair Housing Question: 'Is This a Good Neighborhood?' - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. whether	'whether' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

2. Fair Housing Question: 'Is This a Good Neighborhood?' - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I should not substitute my personal preference for your decision. I can give you property facts and objective sources, and you can decide whether the area fits your needs.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

2. Fair Housing Question: 'Is This a Good Neighborhood?' - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Verify whether, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

3. Listing Presentation: Seller Wants an Unrealistic Price - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. feedback	'feedback' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

3. Listing Presentation: Seller Wants an Unrealistic Price - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Neither do I. My recommendation is a price that creates serious buyer activity and gives us leverage. We can also agree now on a review point if showings or feedback are weak.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

3. Listing Presentation: Seller Wants an Unrealistic Price - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Verify feedback, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

4. Multiple Offers: Stronger Terms vs Higher Price - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

4. Multiple Offers: Stronger Terms vs Higher Price - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. You can choose that strategy, but I want you to understand the risk. Another option is a shorter inspection period, informational inspection, or cap on repair requests, depending on local practice and your comfort level.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

4. Multiple Offers: Stronger Terms vs Higher Price - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

5. Inspection Negotiation: Repair Credit - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

5. Inspection Negotiation: Repair Credit - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Then we evaluate your contract options, your appetite for repairs, and whether a revised price or credit makes the risk acceptable.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

5. Inspection Negotiation: Repair Credit - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

6. Low Appraisal: Contract Price Is Higher Than Appraised Value - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

6. Low Appraisal: Contract Price Is Higher Than Appraised Value - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. First, let's review the appraisal with the lender and compare it to our comps. Then we can choose a negotiation position based on your cash, contract rights, and risk tolerance.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

6. Low Appraisal: Contract Price Is Higher Than Appraised Value - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

7. Financing Delay: Underwriting Conditions - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. owner	'owner' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

7. Financing Delay: Underwriting Conditions - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand your concern. Please send any contract notice through the proper channel. Meanwhile, I will keep the timeline, owner, and dependency clear for everyone.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

7. Financing Delay: Underwriting Conditions - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Verify owner, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

8. RESPA Risk: Referral Benefit - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

8. RESPA Risk: Referral Benefit - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Our policy is to protect clients and avoid referral-kickback risk. I can share your public information with clients if they ask for options, but I cannot trade referrals for benefits.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

8. RESPA Risk: Referral Benefit - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

9. Seller Disclosure: Known Water Intrusion - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. problem	'problem' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

9. Seller Disclosure: Known Water Intrusion - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Clear disclosure with documentation can reduce surprises later. A hidden issue can create a much larger trust and contract problem.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

9. Seller Disclosure: Known Water Intrusion - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Verify problem, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

10. Lead-Based Paint Disclosure - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. forward	'forward' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

10. Lead-Based Paint Disclosure - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. That may be the seller's disclosure position, but the required disclosure process still matters. Let's correct the file before moving forward.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

10. Lead-Based Paint Disclosure - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify forward, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

11. Dual Agency or Same-Brokerage Conflict - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. proceed	'proceed' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

11. Dual Agency or Same-Brokerage Conflict - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I cannot share confidential information from another client or side. My role and limits must be clear before we proceed.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

11. Dual Agency or Same-Brokerage Conflict - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Verify proceed, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

12. Commercial Lease: NNN and TI Allowance - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

12. Commercial Lease: NNN and TI Allowance - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. An LOI can frame the deal, but you should review lease language with legal and financial advisors before committing. Let's compare total occupancy cost, term, options, buildout timeline, and exit risk.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

12. Commercial Lease: NNN and TI Allowance - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.